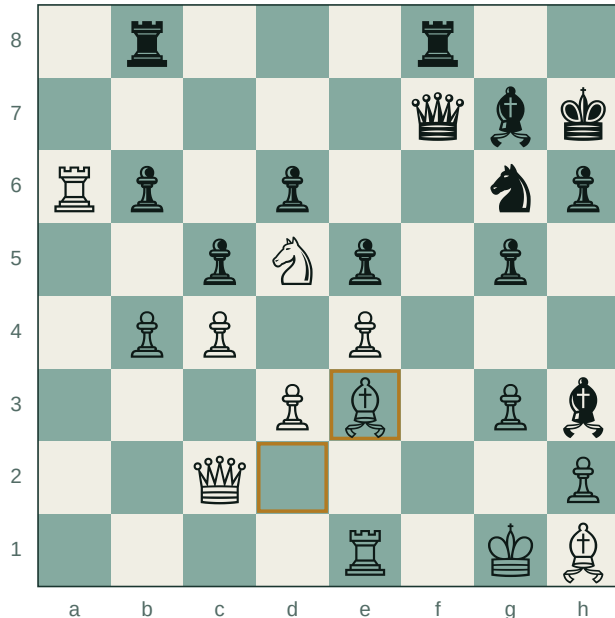


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 25

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Be3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Qf1+ 26. Rxf1 Rxf1#

25...Qf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on e1. Recorded reply: **26.Rxf1.**

26...Rxf1# Mate: rook on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a6 and queen on c2. Check for tactical protection.